

Standard Operating Procedure

Hospital-Wide Internal Audit Programme

«Hospital Name» — Supports PSQ.2.h

SOP No.	[Hospital to define]	Version	1.0
Effective Date	_____	Review Frequency	Annual, or on change
Prepared By Quality Coordinator Name: _____ Signature: _____			
Approved By Medical Superintendent Name: _____ Signature: _____			

1. Purpose

This SOP describes how «Hospital Name» runs its internal audit programme so every area is audited against NABH standards at least once every six months.

2. Scope

Applies to every area and department of the hospital.

3. Responsibility

Quality Coordinator: builds and maintains the 6-monthly audit schedule, and assigns audit teams.

Internal Audit Team: trained staff, independent of the area they are auditing, who conduct the audit and document findings.

4. Procedure

1. Build a rolling schedule that covers every area of the hospital at least once every 6 months. Prioritise areas flagged by KPI trends, past findings, or identified risk.
2. Assign auditors who are trained in NABH Accreditation Standards for Hospitals and who do not work in the area being audited — a pharmacist should not audit the pharmacy.

3. The audit covers all applicable standards and objective elements for that area, not a partial subset chosen informally.
4. At the end of the audit, hold a formal meeting with the area's staff to summarise findings — do not just file a report unread.
5. Document corrective and preventive action for every finding, with an owner and a target date.
6. Verify and record that the corrective action was actually implemented — closing a finding on paper without checking it happened defeats the audit.

5. Records

Supported by the Internal Audit Schedule & Findings Log (Record 9) of the PSQ.2 Required Records pack.

6. Related Documents

Policy on Quality Improvement Programme (HCO/PSQ/POL/02) — PSQ.2 policy, Section 3.8 (internal audits)

7. Review

Reviewed annually, or immediately if an audit cycle reveals a gap in this procedure.

8. References

National Accreditation Board for Hospitals and Healthcare Providers. NABH Accreditation Standards for Hospitals, 6th Edition. PSQ.2.h.